

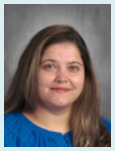
## ENROLLMENT PROCESS:

- **When registering your student for Kindergarten, please indicate your interest in the Dual Language Program.**
- **Complete the Dual Language Program application.**
- **Families will be notified shortly after the lottery* if they were accepted into the program.**

*If demand exceeds the number of spaces available a lottery will be held during the first week of June. Should available spaces open, a second lottery will be held during the first week of August.

## IF YOU ARE LOOKING FOR MORE INFORMATION:

## CONTACT US

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HUDSON PUBLIC SCHOOLS

# DUAL LANGUAGE PROGRAM



"The brain is wired for multilingualism."
Thomas and Collier 2017

**Please visit our website:**
**https://www.hudson.k12.ma.us/parents/dual_language_program**

# WHAT IS THE DUAL LANGUAGE PROGRAM?

Our Dual Language Program helps children become confident learners in both English and Portuguese. Students learn to read, write, speak, and think in two languages while meeting the same academic expectations as all students.

- **Learning in two languages:** Children receive core instruction in both English and Portuguese, so they build strong skills in both languages over time.
- **Strong academics:** The curriculum follows grade-level standards, and research shows that students in dual language programs do just as well, and sometimes better, academically.
- **Learning and growing together:** Students build meaningful relationships across languages and cultures. They learn alongside classmates from different backgrounds, communicate in new ways, and develop a strong sense of belonging in a diverse community.

This program supports language growth, academic success, and strong connections among students and families.

# DESIGNED FOR EVERY KINDERGARTENER:

**This program is a great fit for children who:**

- Are entering kindergarten in Hudson, whether they are new to school or already love learning
- Speak English at home, Portuguese at home, both, or another language
- Are curious, social, or still finding their voice
- Benefit from learning through language, routines, songs, stories, and hands-on experiences
- Grow by learning alongside classmates from different backgrounds and cultures

**Families choose dual language because:**

- Children become bilingual and biliterate at high levels over time
- Learning happens in an inclusive, supportive classroom community
- Research shows dual language programs support high academic achievement for all learners

# FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS:

***Q: Who may enroll in the Dual Language Program?***
**A:** The Dual Langage Program is open to incoming students residing in Hudson!

***Q: Where will the Dual Language Program be held?***
**A:**The program will be held at C. A. Farley Elementary School and is open to all Hudson kindergarten students regardless of which elementary district they reside in.

***Q: How many students are chosen for the Dual Language Program?***
**A:**The Dual Language Program follows the Hudson Public School's policies and guidelines for the number of Kindergarten students in a classroom. Once the classroom roster is filled, all other students remain on the waitlist.

***Q: How are students selected for the Dual Language Program?***
**A:**Families may choose to opt into the Dual Language Program during kindergarten registration. As part of this process, parents will answer a few short questions about the language(s) their child uses. This information helps us create balanced classrooms.

To support learning for all students, children are grouped into language proficiency categories, such as:

- Monolingual English speakers
- Bilingual English/Spanish speakers
- Bilingual Portuguese speakers
- Monolingual Portuguese speakers

Our goal is to have a similar number of students in each group so that all children can learn from and with one another. If more students apply than there are available spaces, students are placed into these groups based on the information families share. Once a group is full, additional students are placed on a waitlist.If spaces are still open in August, all students on the waitlist will be included in a final lottery. At that point, remaining seats are filled regardless of language group to ensure all available spaces are used. This process helps us build strong, balanced classrooms that support language learning for every child.

***Q: Is there bus transportation available for the Dual Language Program?***
**A:** Bus transportation is provided for students who live more than one mile from Farley Elementary in the Farley District **or** who reside in the Forest Avenue or Mulready Districts.

***Q: When my student is accepted into the program, what are the next steps?***
**A:** Once accepted, caregivers are asked to attend a required orientation and information session, offered on multiple dates and times for convenience. Specific dates and times will be shared in the acceptance letter or email. This session provides an opportunity to learn more about the program, review expectations, and ask questions. To finalize enrollment, a Letter of Commitment must be signed by a caregiver.

***Q: Is the curriculum in the Dual Language Program different?***
**A:** The Dual Language Program's instruction is built around rich topics and themes from the district's social studies and science units so students develop strong knowledge while learning in two languages. Units are carefully planned to meet Massachusetts curriculum standards, WIDA, and ACTFL standards for both languages. The program adds the benefit of becoming bilingual and biliterate while learning the same content as their peers.

***Q: What type of Dual Language Program does Hudson have?***
**A:** The Dual Language Education (DLE) program is an additive, two-language program that brings together students from different language backgrounds to learn academic content in both English and a partner language. In elementary school (grades K–4), the program uses a 50/50 model, with instruction evenly divided between English and the partner language. Students follow the district's curriculum while developing strong skills in reading, writing, speaking, and listening in both languages. The program is designed to build bilingualism, biliteracy, and cross-cultural understanding while ensuring students meet grade-level expectations in all subjects.

***Q: What if my child finds learning two languages or the curriculum challenging?***
**A:**Learning two languages is a rewarding process that looks different for every child. It is normal for students to experience periods of challenge as they build new language skills. Our teachers closely support all students in this program and use many strategies to help children succeed. Families and teachers work together as partners, and we encourage open communication if questions or concerns arise. With time, support, and consistency, students grow in confidence and ability in both languages.

